Ratan's love for dogs is legendary. It all began when he was twelve years old and got a fox terrier. He loved the dog as much as his grandmother hated it. But that was not for long. Lady Tata's dislike for the dog melted after Ratan left for the US in 1954. '[He] used to sit on her lap, something unbelievable, and they became inseparable,' Ratan amusedly recalls. 'When she grew old and used to have her naps in her room on late mornings, he always sat on her chair next to her.'

His second dog was the German Shepherd Tito, the pup from Jamshedpur. Tito lived for nearly fifteen years and became Ratan's constant companion, accompanying him on his morning walks and to the beaches on weekends. Tito was like his child. Nothing made Ratan happier than taking Tito wherever he could.

He even took Tito to social functions. It was not unusual to see the dog sitting with Ratan in the front row at events. They went on long car rides and walks to escape the pressures of corporate life. Ratan confided to *The Telegraph*, London, in 2007: 'There is a great sense of loneliness from time to time … I would be lying or hypocritical if I said there wasn't. But then I have [my] dogs, and they are part of my life.'

By 1995, Tito had slowed down. Ratan got another German Shepherd called Tango to fill the void. The two dogs became friends. Tito died in 1998. His passing left Ratan heartbroken. He had stolen Ratan's heart with one look and was the first pet to live most of its life with him. Tito was with him through joys and tribulations, distracting him when he was stressed and helping him escape his loneliness. When Ratan resigned as director from some of the Tata companies in 1988 after a brief disagreement with JRD, he took off with his buddy to his beach house in Alibaug to escape the blues. A large photo of the handsome Tito occupies prime position in the corridor. It appears as if he is zealously guarding his master in death as much as he did when he was alive.

Tango passed away in 2004. His departure was also painful for Ratan. After a wait of five lonely months, he got two more German Shepherds. He named them Tito and Tango too. It was the beginning of some terribly busy years for Ratan—he would soon embark on his foreign acquisitions' spree. He did not have the luxury of time to spend with his pets. His morning walks became shorter, but his two furry friends never failed to accompany their master whenever they could. Despite all the pressures of work, he never forgot to say bye to them before leaving for office.